

> **"Why do G7 countries call themselves the Big 7? In terms of purchasing power parity, India's is the 3rd largest economy in the world. Where are countries like the UK? 10th?"**

> **"New centres of global growth are emerging rapidly. These include countries of the Global South—South Asia, India, Indonesia, Africa"**

> **"The current relationship between Russia and European countries is far from normal. But other major alliances like BRICS, SCO are forming. We are involved everywhere"**

effective ways to resolve them. In large alliances like BRICS, or the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, we share a common understanding that we have common values rooted in our traditional beliefs, which underpin our civilisations such as India's civilisation, for already hundreds, if not thousands, of years. Drawing on this heritage of the past, we work together instead of suppressing opportunities. When efforts are combined, the resulting synergy turns out unexpectedly strong and high. We never set out to come up with ways to deceive, outsmart, or hinder someone's development. Nothing like that has ever happened. We always focus only on positive agendas. I believe that's important.

Q. How do you make it economically viable? Are we looking at alternative payment systems? Is there going to be a BRICS currency? Moving towards de-dollarisation basically.

A. If you don't rush into this, you'll avoid big mistakes. For instance, we were talking about Europe. They set up the Euro system and dragged in there certain countries that weren't economically ready for one single strong currency. And now they're dealing with some difficult social matters. There's more than just playing around with inflation there, right? This question is far more complex than just tinkering with inflation a little bit and calling it done. Their entire economy is tied to just one stable currency, therefore social problems arise and budgetary issues emerge. Right now, we don't aim at having a single currency within BRICS. In this process, there's no rush anywhere, and we aren't rushing either. There is a need to expand the use of national currencies, you've mentioned this already. We must make better use of the BRICS New Development Bank's opportunities. For example, we propose creating a new investment platform using electronic payments (with an initial capital of $100 billion) to encourage joint investments both in our economies and those of developing nations in the Global South. I believe this could be a very appealing option, because these investments would help us, and they would also benefit the recipient countries, since together we would produce high-quality goods at reasonable prices. These products could help the countries of the Global South to develop further, while also advancing our own growth.

Q. What about the issues between India and Russia, like our rupee-rouble payments?

A. There are no obstacles here. These are purely economic issues. We fully understand and realise that we do have a certain trade imbalance. However, India's government does not impose restrictions on our mutual trade. Why? Because they need both oil and petroleum products. The Indian government needs to expand its purchases of Russian fertilisers because these are crucial for Indian farmers, and Prime Minister Modi constantly raises this issue: "Please increase the volume of deliveries." The issue is entirely different. It's not about rupees; it's about what those rupees can buy